

07

Positional Najdorf Systems

6.Be2, 6.g3, and 6.a4: quieter moves that punish careless structure rather than the king.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will meet positional systems without relaxing, using sound development and precise central breaks.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 037 | PAGE 4

Decode: 6.Be2 and the d5 outpost*Against Be2, solve d5 first and attack second.*

LESSON 038 | PAGE 8

Play: 6.Be2 and the d5 outpost*Against Be2, solve d5 first and attack second.*

LESSON 039 | PAGE 12

Decode: 6.g3 kingside fianchetto*Quiet systems still contain a race, but the currency is squares rather than checks.*

LESSON 040 | PAGE 16

Play: 6.g3 kingside fianchetto*Quiet systems still contain a race, but the currency is squares rather than checks.*

LESSON 041 | PAGE 20

Decode: 6.a4 restrains ...b5*When a wing plan is restrained, switch fronts; do not force the locked door.*

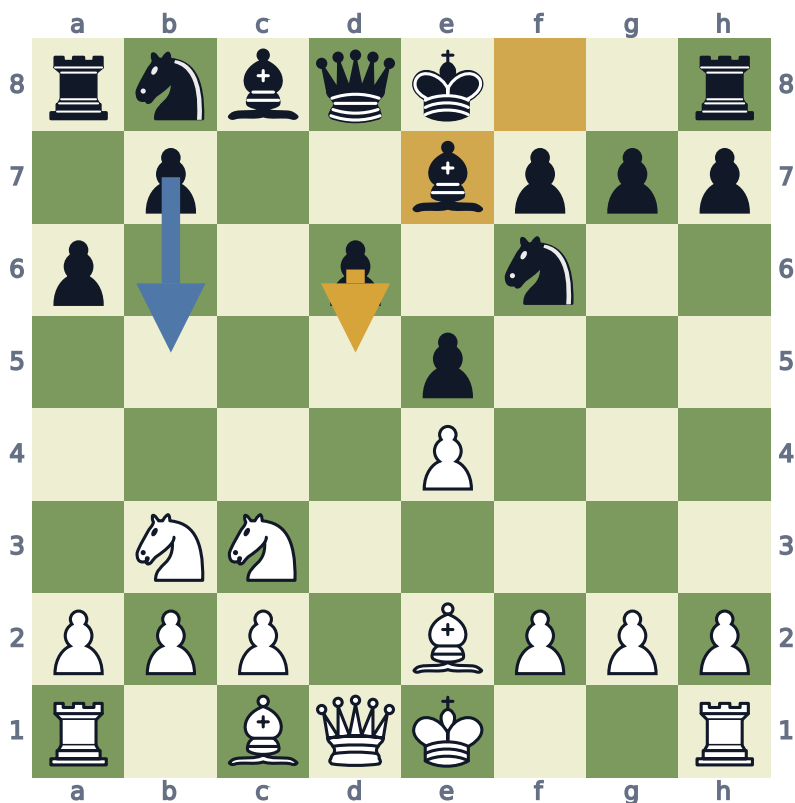
LESSON 042 | PAGE 24

Play: 6.a4 restrains ...b5*When a wing plan is restrained, switch fronts; do not force the locked door.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will meet positional systems without relaxing, using sound development and precise central breaks.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: 6.Be2 and the d5 outpost



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

White develops without committing the king to a race, then pressures d5 and may expand with f4.

DECISION RULE

Which exchange reduces White's control of d5 without creating a new weakness?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Secure d5, coordinate rooks, and choose queenside play only after the center is stable.

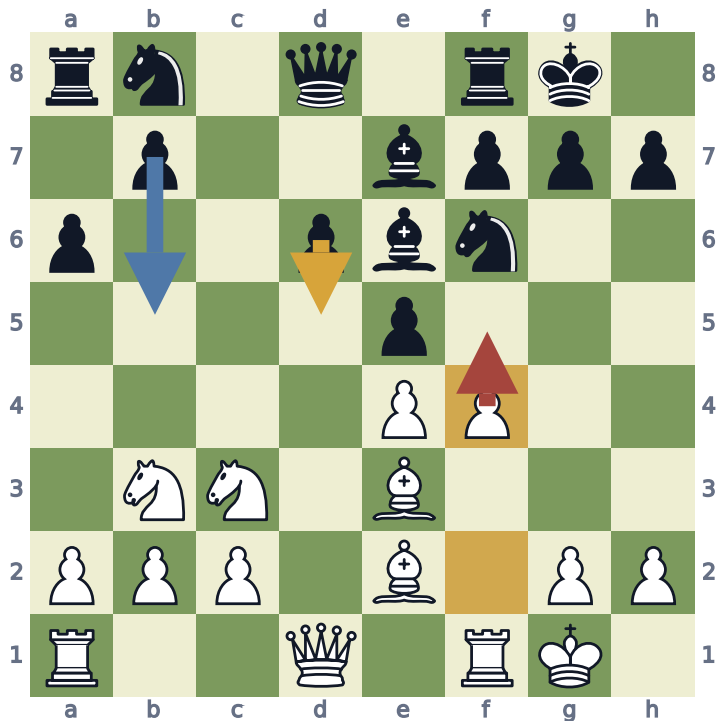
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses Nd5, f4-f5, and pressure on d6 in a controlled positional squeeze.

MEMORY RULE | Against Be2, solve d5 first and attack second.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White develops without committing the king to a race, then pressures d5 and may expand with f4.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Secure d5, coordinate rooks, and choose queenside play only after the center is stable.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White uses Nd5, f4-f5, and pressure on d6 in a controlled positional squeeze.

FAILURE MODE

Playing as if a direct attack is required when patient central defense is enough.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which exchange reduces White's control of d5 without creating a new weakness? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

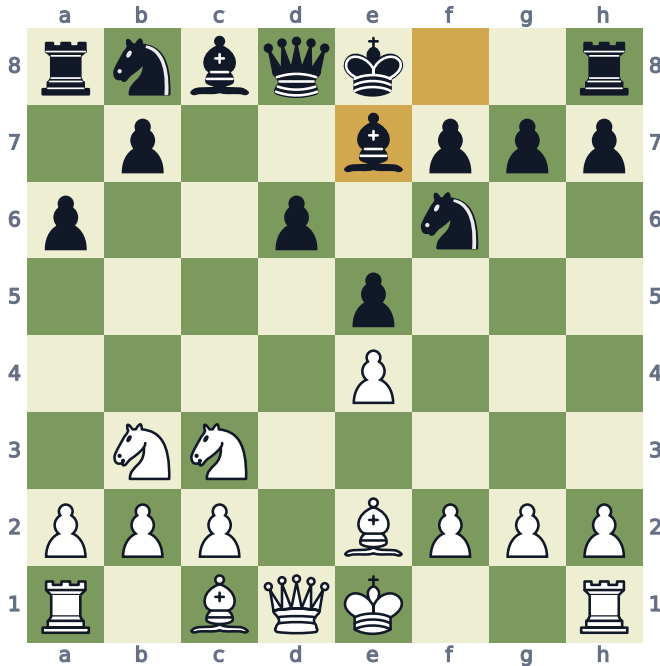
RULE | Against Be2, solve d5 first and attack second.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be2 e5 7. Nb3 Be7 8. O-O O-O 9. Be3 Be6 10. f4



- Nc3: White reroutes a knight to c3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- a6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- e5: Black gains central space and a knight tempo while accepting a lasting weakness on d5.
- Nb3: White reroutes a knight to b3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

White develops without committing the king to a race, then pressures d5 and may expand with f4.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which exchange reduces White's control of d5 without creating a new weakness? White's resistance is: White uses Nd5, f4-f5, and pressure on d6 in a controlled positional squeeze. The line fails as a template when: Playing as if a direct attack is required when patient central defense is enough.

STORE THIS | Against Be2, solve d5 first and attack second.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

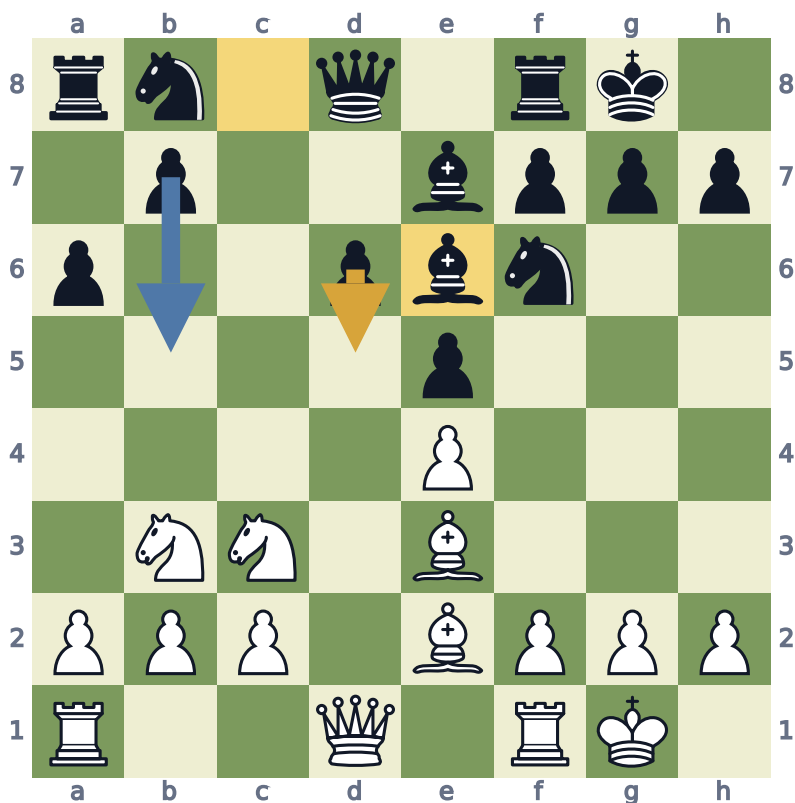
1. White develops without committing the king to a race, then pressures d5 and may expand with f4. 2. Secure d5, coordinate rooks, and choose queenside play only after the center is stable. 3. White uses Nd5, f4-f5, and pressure on d6 in a controlled positional squeeze. 4. Which exchange reduces White's control of d5 without creating a new weakness? 5. Playing as if a direct attack is required when patient central defense is enough.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be2 e5 7. Nb3 Be7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: 6.Be2 and the d5 outpost

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

White develops without committing the king to a race, then pressures d5 and may expand with f4.

DECISION RULE

Which exchange reduces White's control of d5 without creating a new weakness?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Secure d5, coordinate rooks, and choose queenside play only after the center is stable.

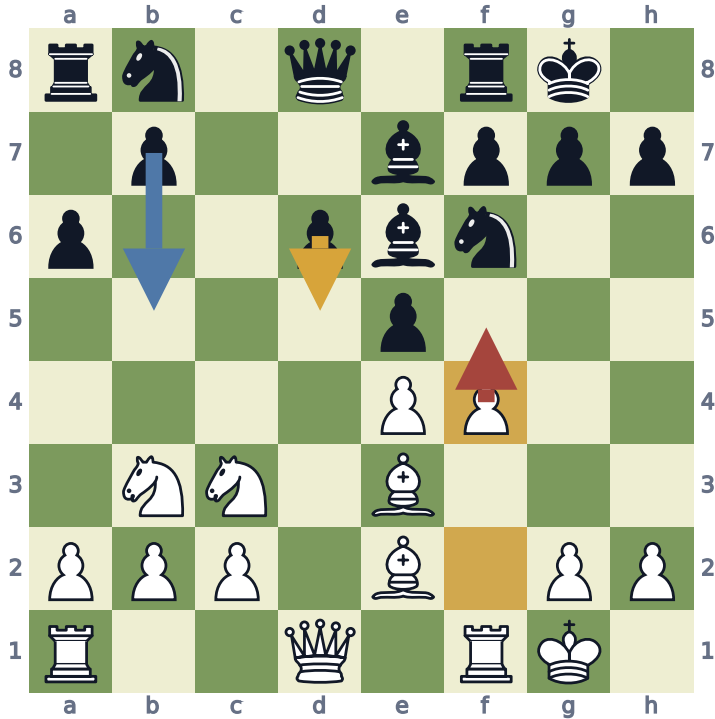
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses Nd5, f4-f5, and pressure on d6 in a controlled positional squeeze.

MEMORY RULE | Against Be2, solve d5 first and attack second.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White develops without committing the king to a race, then pressures d5 and may expand with f4.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Secure d5, coordinate rooks, and choose queenside play only after the center is stable.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White uses Nd5, f4-f5, and pressure on d6 in a controlled positional squeeze.

FAILURE MODE

Playing as if a direct attack is required when patient central defense is enough.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which exchange reduces White's control of d5 without creating a new weakness? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

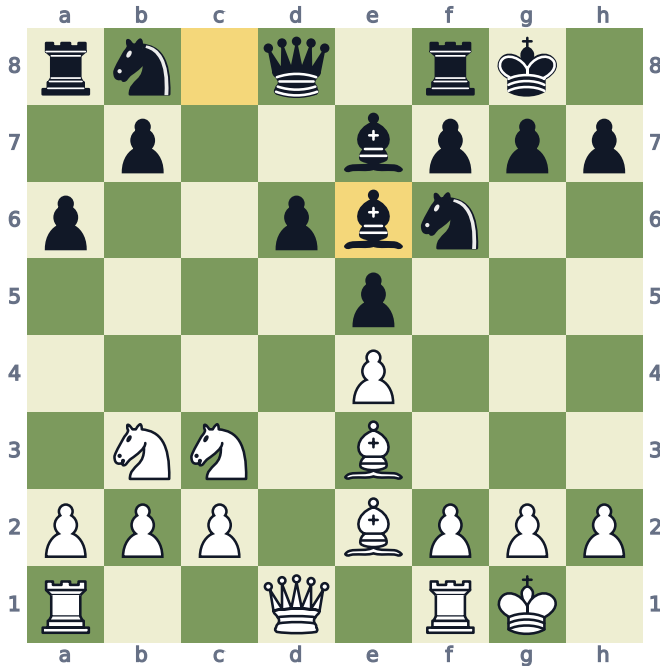
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be2 e5 7. Nb3 Be7 8. O-O O-O 9. Be3 Be6 10. f4



- Nb3: White reroutes a knight to b3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Be3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Be6: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

White develops without committing the king to a race, then pressures d5 and may expand with f4.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which exchange reduces White's control of d5 without creating a new weakness? White's resistance is: White uses Nd5, f4-f5, and pressure on d6 in a controlled positional squeeze. The line fails as a template when: Playing as if a direct attack is required when patient central defense is enough.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

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2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

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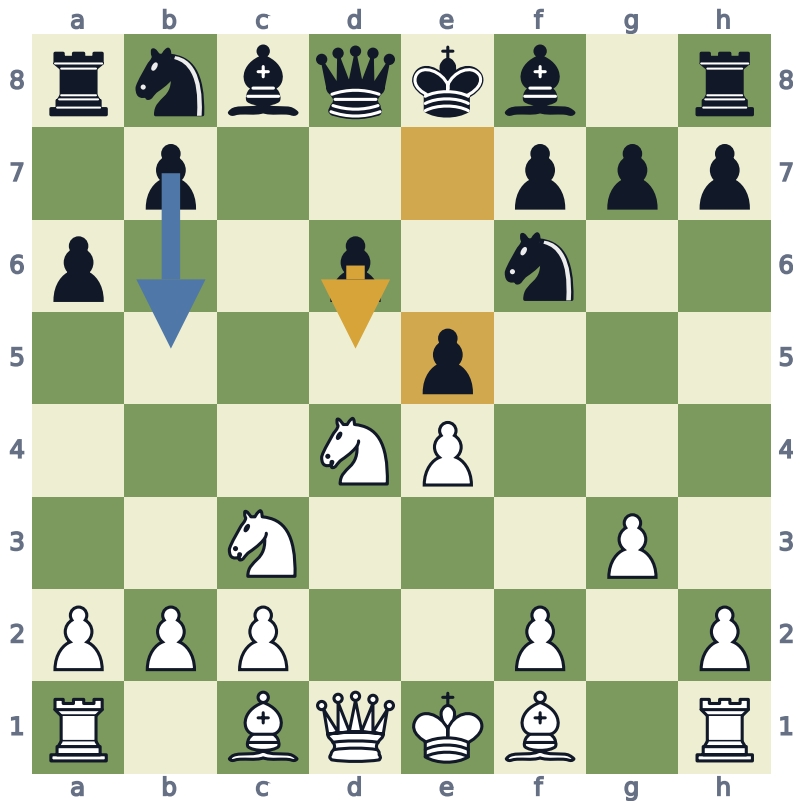
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. Nb3 Be7 8. O-O O-O 9. Be3 Be6

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: 6.g3 kingside fianchetto

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

The fianchetto controls dark squares and supports a slower central game; White reduces tactical targets and keeps several pawn breaks available.

DECISION RULE

Can Black improve queenside space without weakening the diagonal toward the king?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Take space with ...b5, control d5, and prevent White from achieving a cost-free f4 or Nd5 setup.

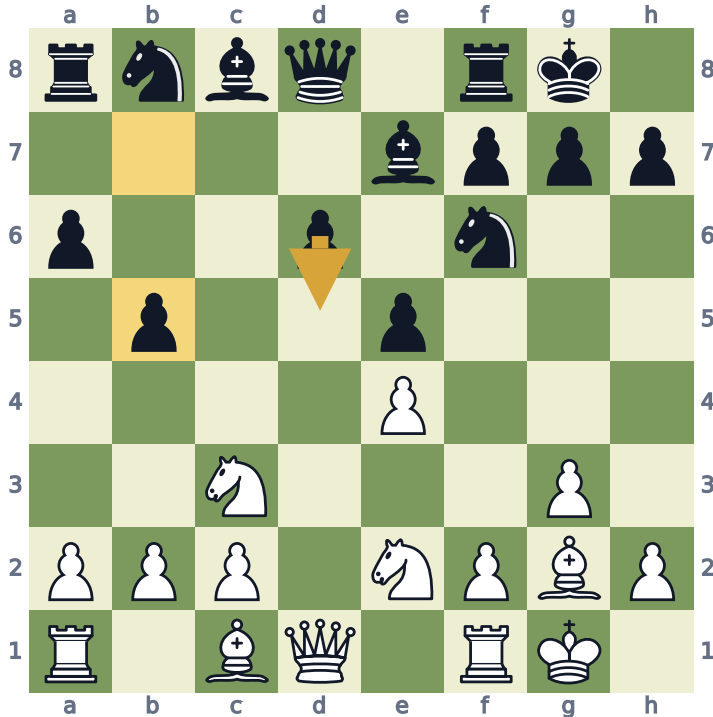
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White reroutes pieces, uses f4, and exploits the long diagonal once the center opens.

MEMORY RULE | Quiet systems still contain a race, but the currency is squares rather than checks.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The fianchetto controls dark squares and supports a slower central game; White reduces tactical targets and keeps several pawn breaks available.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Take space with ...b5, control d5, and prevent White from achieving a cost-free f4 or Nd5 setup.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White reroutes pieces, uses f4, and exploits the long diagonal once the center opens.

FAILURE MODE

Forcing tactics in a position whose main demand is patient square control.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Can Black improve queenside space without weakening the diagonal toward the king? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

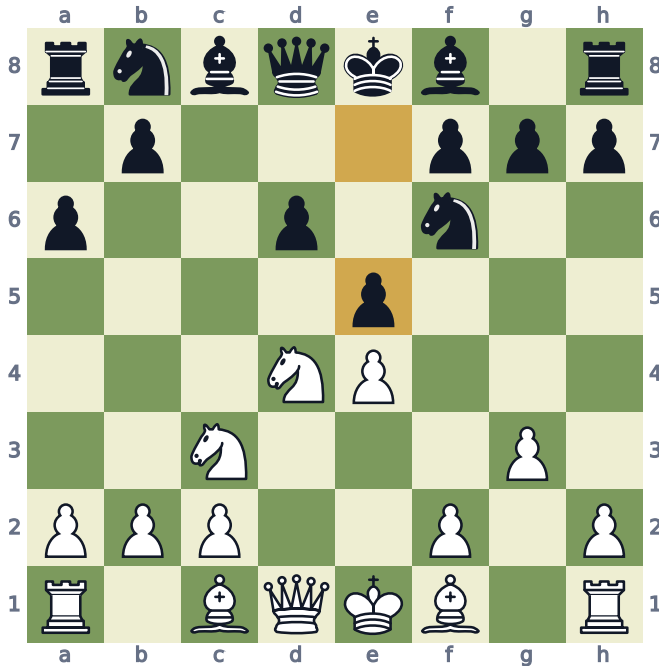
RULE | Quiet systems still contain a race, but the currency is squares rather than checks.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. g3 e5 7. Nde2 Be7 8. Bg2 O-O 9. O-O b5



- Nxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight to c3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- a6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- g3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- e5: Black gains central space and a knight tempo while accepting a lasting weakness on d5.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The fianchetto controls dark squares and supports a slower central game; White reduces tactical targets and keeps several pawn breaks available.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Can Black improve queenside space without weakening the diagonal toward the king? White's resistance is: White reroutes pieces, uses f4, and exploits the long diagonal once the center opens. The line fails as a template when: Forcing tactics in a position whose main demand is patient square control.

STORE THIS | Quiet systems still contain a race, but the currency is squares rather than checks.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

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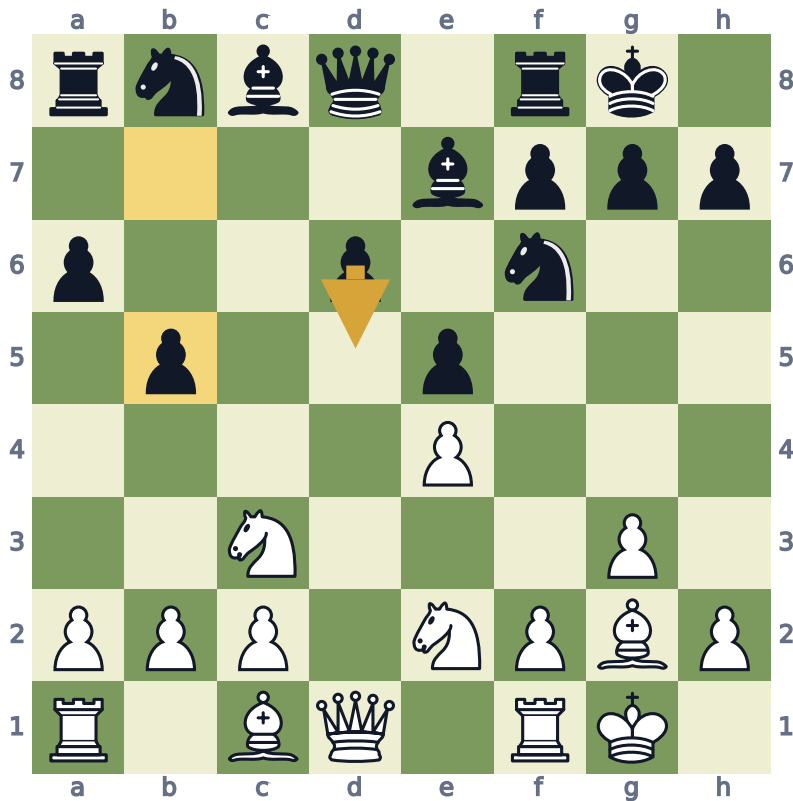
1. The fianchetto controls dark squares and supports a slower central game; White reduces tactical targets and keeps several pawn breaks available. 2. Take space with ...b5, control d5, and prevent White from achieving a cost-free f4 or Nd5 setup. 3. White reroutes pieces, uses f4, and exploits the long diagonal once the center opens. 4. Can Black improve queenside space without weakening the diagonal toward the king? 5. Forcing tactics in a position whose main demand is patient square control.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. g3 e5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: 6.g3 kingside fianchetto



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The fianchetto controls dark squares and supports a slower central game; White reduces tactical targets and keeps several pawn breaks available.

DECISION RULE

Can Black improve queenside space without weakening the diagonal toward the king?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

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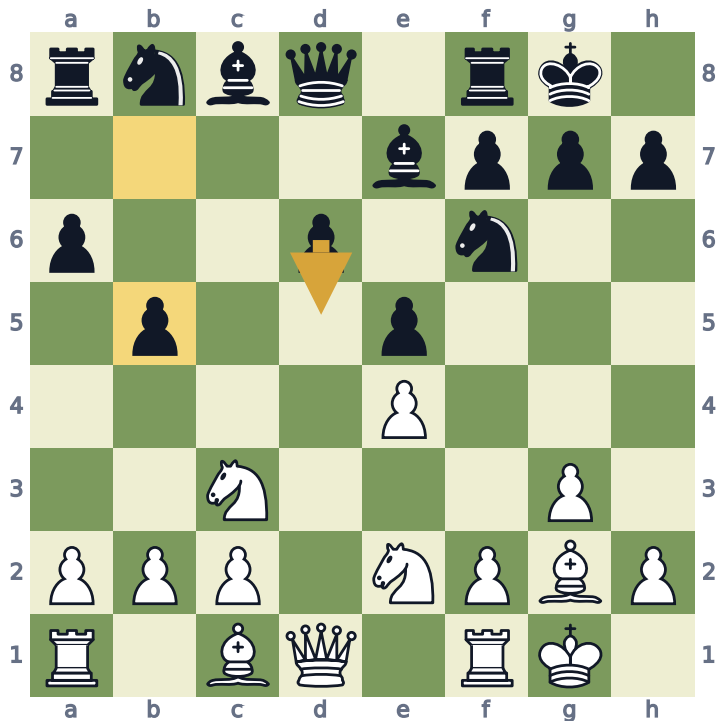
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White reroutes pieces, uses f4, and exploits the long diagonal once the center opens.

MEMORY RULE | Quiet systems still contain a race, but the currency is squares rather than checks.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The fianchetto controls dark squares and supports a slower central game; White reduces tactical targets and keeps several pawn breaks available.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Take space with ...b5, control d5, and prevent White from achieving a cost-free f4 or Nd5 setup.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White reroutes pieces, uses f4, and exploits the long diagonal once the center opens.

FAILURE MODE

Forcing tactics in a position whose main demand is patient square control.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Can Black improve queenside space without weakening the diagonal toward the king? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

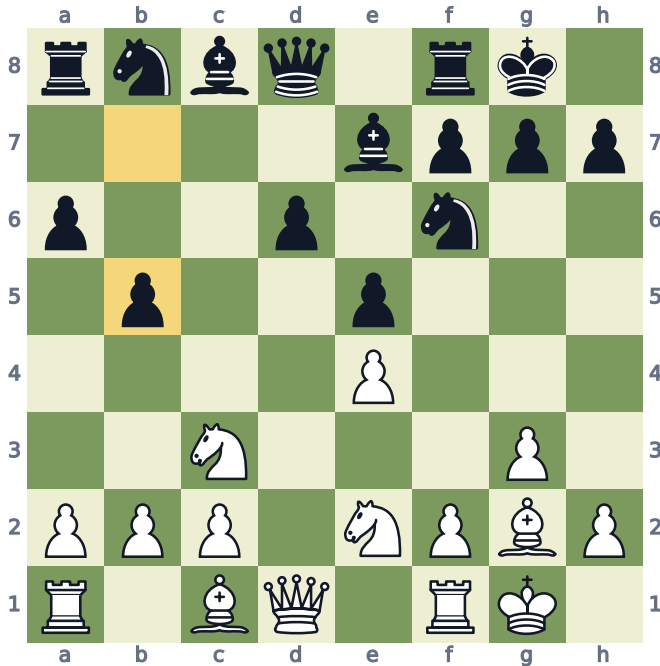
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. g3 e5 7. Nde2 Be7 8. Bg2 O-O 9. O-O b5



- Nde2: White reroutes a knight to e2; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- b5: Black starts queenside expansion and prepares files or a bishop diagonal.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The fianchetto controls dark squares and supports a slower central game; White reduces tactical targets and keeps several pawn breaks available.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Can Black improve queenside space without weakening the diagonal toward the king? White's resistance is: White reroutes pieces, uses f4, and exploits the long diagonal once the center opens. The line fails as a template when: Forcing tactics in a position whose main demand is patient square control.

STORE THIS | Quiet systems still contain a race, but the currency is squares rather than checks.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

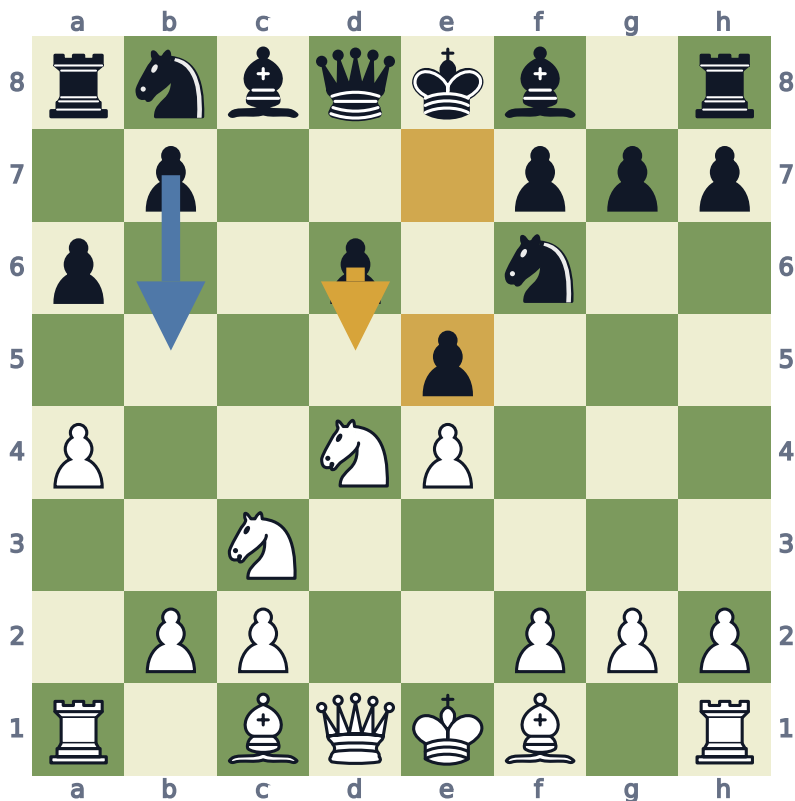
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. Nde2 Be7 8. Bg2 O-O 9. O-O b5

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: 6.a4 restrains ...b5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

a4 spends a tempo to restrain the most natural Najdorf expansion, inviting Black to prove another source of counterplay.

DECISION RULE

If ...b5 is restricted, which central or piece break replaces it?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use development and central control; prepare ...Be6, ...Nc6, or ...d5 instead of forcing a weakened ...b5.

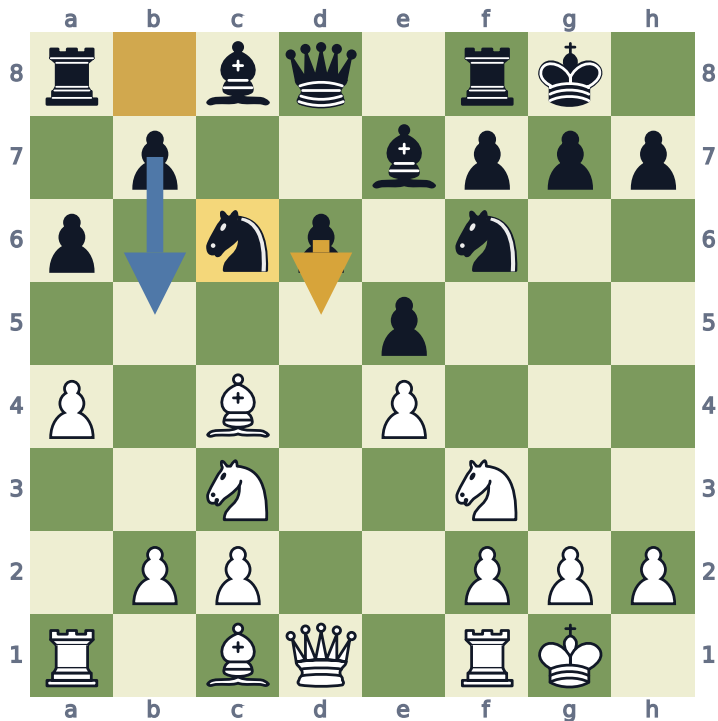
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White fixes b5, develops rapidly, and may occupy d5 before Black creates play.

MEMORY RULE | When a wing plan is restrained, switch fronts; do not force the locked door.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

a4 spends a tempo to restrain the most natural Najdorf expansion, inviting Black to prove another source of counterplay.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use development and central control; prepare ...Be6, ...Nc6, or ...d5 instead of forcing a weakened ...b5.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White fixes b5, develops rapidly, and may occupy d5 before Black creates play.

FAILURE MODE

Playing ...b5 anyway and creating exploitable a- and b-pawn weaknesses.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If ...b5 is restricted, which central or piece break replaces it? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

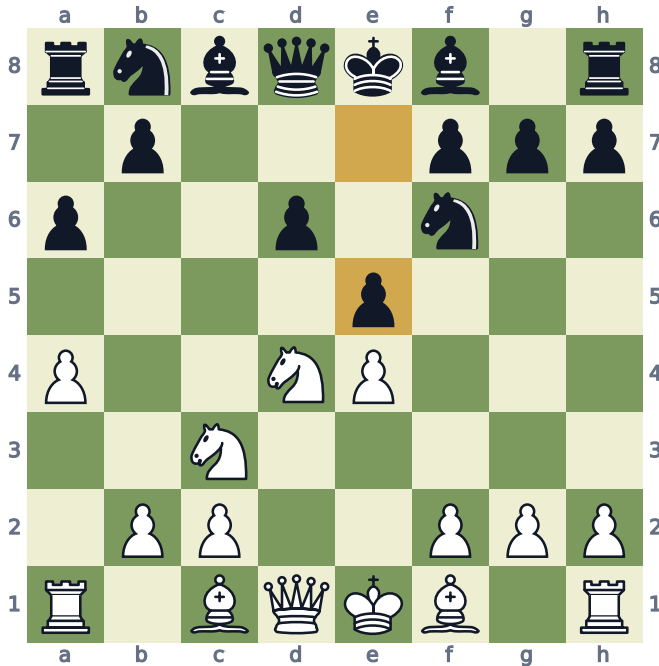
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. a4 e5 7. Nf3 Be7 8. Bc4 O-O 9. O-O Nc6



- Nxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight to c3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- a6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- a4: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- e5: Black gains central space and a knight tempo while accepting a lasting weakness on d5.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

a4 spends a tempo to restrain the most natural Najdorf expansion, inviting Black to prove another source of counterplay.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

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ANSWER KEY

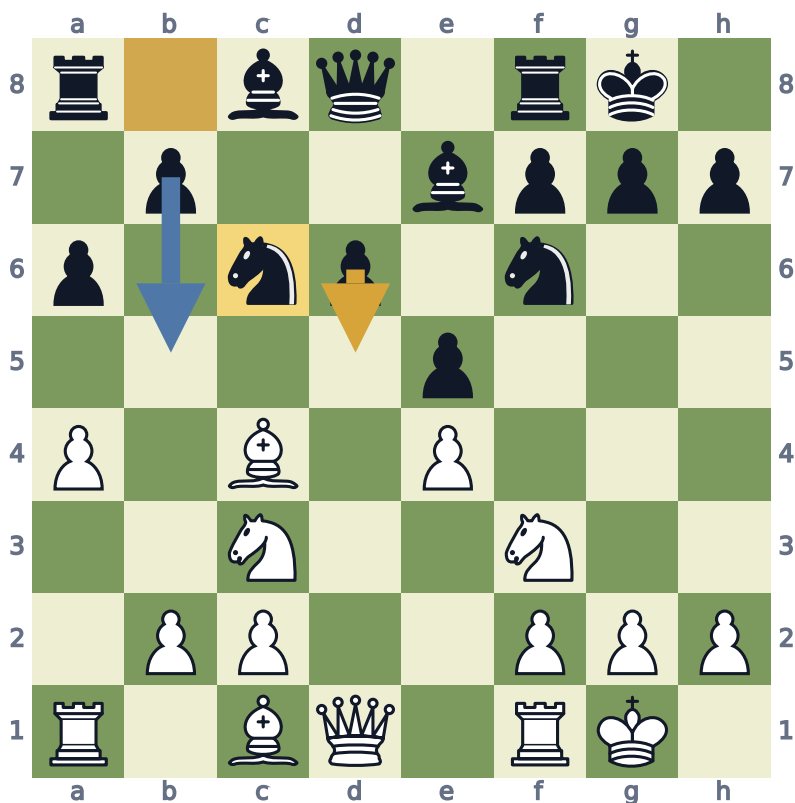
1. a4 spends a tempo to restrain the most natural Najdorf expansion, inviting Black to prove another source of counterplay. 2. Use development and central control; prepare ...Be6, ...Nc6, or ...d5 instead of forcing a weakened ...b5. 3. White fixes b5, develops rapidly, and may occupy d5 before Black creates play. 4. If ...b5 is restricted, which central or piece break replaces it? 5. Playing ...b5 anyway and creating exploitable a- and b-pawn weaknesses.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. a4 e5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: 6.a4 restrains ...b5

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

a4 spends a tempo to restrain the most natural Najdorf expansion, inviting Black to prove another source of counterplay.

DECISION RULE

If ...b5 is restricted, which central or piece break replaces it?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

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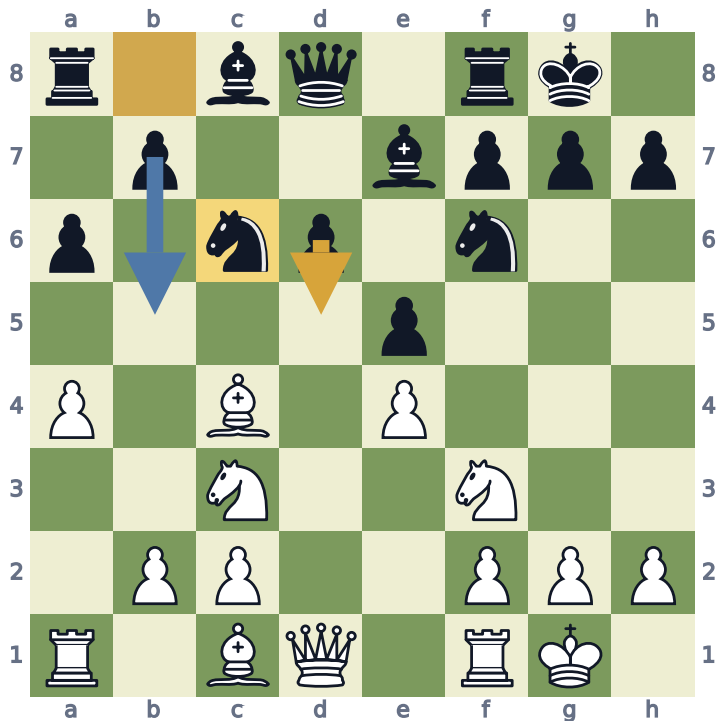
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MEMORY RULE | When a wing plan is restrained, switch fronts; do not force the locked door.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

a4 spends a tempo to restrain the most natural Najdorf expansion, inviting Black to prove another source of counterplay.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Use development and central control; prepare ...Be6, ...Nc6, or ...d5 instead of forcing a weakened ...b5.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

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FAILURE MODE

Playing ...b5 anyway and creating exploitable a- and b-pawn weaknesses.

DECISION TEST

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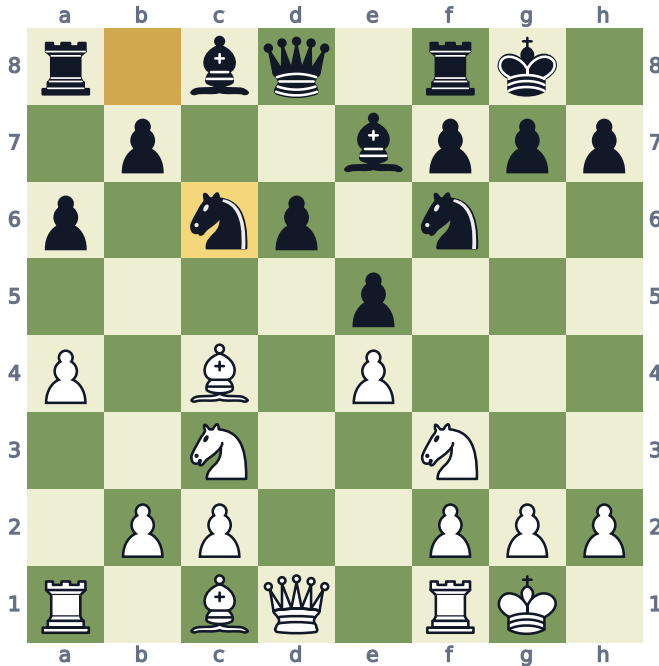
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Move-by-move meaning

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- Nf3: White reroutes a knight to f3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bc4: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

a4 spends a tempo to restrain the most natural Najdorf expansion, inviting Black to prove another source of counterplay.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

If ...b5 is restricted, which central or piece break replaces it? White's resistance is: White fixes b5, develops rapidly, and may occupy d5 before Black creates play. The line fails as a template when: Playing ...b5 anyway and creating exploitable a- and b-pawn weaknesses.

STORE THIS | When a wing plan is restrained, switch fronts; do not force the locked door.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. a4 spends a tempo to restrain the most natural Najdorf expansion, inviting Black to prove another source of counterplay. 2. Use development and central control; prepare ...Be6, ...Nc6, or ...d5 instead of forcing a weakened ...b5. 3. White fixes b5, develops rapidly, and may occupy d5 before Black creates play. 4. If ...b5 is restricted, which central or piece break replaces it? 5. Playing ...b5 anyway and creating exploitable a- and b-pawn weaknesses.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. Nf3 Be7 8. Bc4 O-O 9. O-O Nc6

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 037 Decode: 6.Be2 and the d5 outpost

Prompt: Which exchange reduces White's control of d5 without creating a new weakness?

Recall: Against Be2, solve d5 first and attack second.

LESSON 038 Play: 6.Be2 and the d5 outpost

Prompt: Which exchange reduces White's control of d5 without creating a new weakness?

Recall: Against Be2, solve d5 first and attack second.

LESSON 039 Decode: 6.g3 kingside fianchetto

Prompt: Can Black improve queenside space without weakening the diagonal toward the king?

Recall: Quiet systems still contain a race, but the currency is squares rather than checks.

LESSON 040 Play: 6.g3 kingside fianchetto

Prompt: Can Black improve queenside space without weakening the diagonal toward the king?

Recall: Quiet systems still contain a race, but the currency is squares rather than checks.

LESSON 041 Decode: 6.a4 restrains ...b5

Prompt: If ...b5 is restricted, which central or piece break replaces it?

Recall: When a wing plan is restrained, switch fronts; do not force the locked door.

LESSON 042 Play: 6.a4 restrains ...b5

Prompt: If ...b5 is restricted, which central or piece break replaces it?

Recall: When a wing plan is restrained, switch fronts; do not force the locked door.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

6.Be2 and the d5 outpost

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be2 e5 7. Nb3 Be7 8. O-O O-O 9. Be3 Be6 10. f4

Decision: Which exchange reduces White's control of d5 without creating a new weakness?

Memory: Against Be2, solve d5 first and attack second.

CARD 2

6.g3 kingside fianchetto

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. g3 e5 7. Nde2 Be7 8. Bg2 O-O 9. O-O b5

Decision: Can Black improve queenside space without weakening the diagonal toward the king?

Memory: Quiet systems still contain a race, but the currency is squares rather than checks.

CARD 3

6.a4 restrains ...b5

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. a4 e5 7. Nf3 Be7 8. Bc4 O-O 9. O-O Nc6

Decision: If ...b5 is restricted, which central or piece break replaces it?

Memory: When a wing plan is restrained, switch fronts; do not force the locked door.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
037 Decode: 6.Be2 and the d5 outpost	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
038 Play: 6.Be2 and the d5 outpost	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
039 Decode: 6.g3 kingside fianchetto	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
040 Play: 6.g3 kingside fianchetto	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
041 Decode: 6.a4 restrains ...b5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
042 Play: 6.a4 restrains ...b5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.